

Jacob Burger

PhD Candidate in Linguistics

📍 Newark, DE ✉️ jburger@udel.edu

Education

PhD	University of Delaware , Linguistics	Newark, DE 2022 – present
	• Advisor: Dr. Arild Hestvik • Committee: Dr. Arild Hestvik (Chair), Dr. Alon Hafri, Dr. F. Sayako Earle, Dr. William Idsardi (University of Maryland)	
BA	Georgetown University , Linguistics	Washington, DC 2018 – 2022
	• Minor in Government • Minor in German	

Research Experience

University of Delaware — Experimental Psycholinguistics Lab , Lab Manager	Newark, DE Jan 2024 – present
PI: Dr. Arild Hestvik	
• Lab Manager (2024-present) • Research Assistant (2023-present)	
Georgetown University — Dept of Linguistics , Research Assistant	Washington, DC Jan 2020 – Dec 2021
Advisor: Dr. Nick Mararac	
• Project: U.S. Military Veterans in Higher Education	

Teaching Experience

University of Delaware , Introduction to Cognitive Science — Instructor of Record	Newark, DE Jan 2024 – Dec 2025
University of Delaware , Introduction to Cognitive Science — Teaching Assistant	Newark, DE Jan 2023 – May 2026
University of Delaware , Introduction to Linguistics — Teaching Assistant	Newark, DE Jan 2023
University of Delaware , Science of Language — Teaching Assistant	Newark, DE Jan 2022
Georgetown University , Summer High School Programs — Mentor	Washington, DC Jan 2021

Professional Experience

University of Delaware , Graduate Student Government President — Graduate Assistantship	Newark, DE Jan 2026 – present
Educational Testing Service , Summer Associate	Jan 2023
SoKat Consulting, LLC , AI/ML Engineer Intern	Jan 2022
US Census Bureau , Enumerator	Jan 2020

Outreach & Professional Development

University of Delaware , Graduate Student Government — President	Newark, DE Jan 2026 – present
University of Delaware , Jewish Graduate Organization — President and Co-Founder	Newark, DE Jan 2025 – Dec 2026
University of Delaware , Graduate Student Government — Senator for Linguistics and Cognitive Science	Newark, DE Jan 2024 – Dec 2026
Georgetown University , Jewish Life — Member	Washington, DC Sept 2018 – May 2022
Georgetown University , Georgetown Gaming — Captain of the Super Smash Brothers Team	Washington, DC Jan 2020 – Dec 2021

Awards, Fellowships & Grants

Travel Award UD Dept of Linguistics and Cognitive Science — \$600	Jan 2025
Travel Award UD Dept of Linguistics and Cognitive Science — \$500	Jan 2025
Summer Research Award UD Dept of Linguistics and Cognitive Science — \$3,600	Jan 2024
Summer Research Award UD Dept of Linguistics and Cognitive Science — \$2,400	Jan 2023

Publications

‘Negation-blind’ N400 effect disappears when lexical priming is Controlled D. Asami, C. Han, <i>J. Burger</i> , D. Dunlop, Y. Lu, E. Morad, C. Zhao, A. Hestvik doi.org/10.3765/elm.3.5800 (Experiments in Linguistic Meaning, 3, 19–31)	Jan 2025
Unaccusative Applicatives, Nominal Licensing, and a Hybrid Theory of Case <i>J. Burger</i> , B. Bruening (Linguistic Inquiry (under review))	Jan 2026
Spectrally Rotated Speech Reveals Evidence for Underspecification in English <i>J. Burger</i> , C. Han, W. Idsardi, A. Hestvik (In preparation)	
Chronobiology Modulates Latency of Auditory ERP Waves <i>J. Burger</i> , S. Earle (In preparation)	
Production and Perception Asymmetries in Phonological and Morphosyntactic Processing Decoded with Scalp EEG <i>J. Burger</i> , A. Hestvik (In preparation)	

Conference Presentations

Separating acoustics from phonology with rotated speech

Sept 2025

J. Burger, A. Hestvik, W. Idsardi, C. Han, A. Knox, T. Hill

(Poster, Society of Neurobiology of Language 17th Annual Meeting (SNL 2025), Washington, DC)

Neural Investigation of Underspecification with Rotated Speech

May 2025

J. Burger, A. Hestvik, C. Han, T. Hill, W. Idsardi, A. Knox, A. Alromihi

(Oral presentation, 13th North American Phonology Conference (NAPhCxiii), Montreal, Quebec)

YODA: English as SOV preserves N400 evidence for 2-stage negation processing

Mar 2025

A. Alromihi, J. Burger, A. Knox, T. Hill, A. Hestvik

(Poster, 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2025), College Park, MD)

‘Negation-blind’ N400 effect disappears when lexical priming is controlled

June 2024

D. Asami, C. Han, J. Burger, D. Dunlop, Y. Lu, E. Morad, C. Zhao, A. Hestvik

(Poster, 3rd Experiments in Linguistic Meaning Conference (ELM3), Philadelphia, PA)

‘Negation-blind’ N400 effect disappears when lexical priming is controlled

May 2024

D. Asami, C. Han, J. Burger, D. Dunlop, Y. Lu, E. Morad, N. Silva, C. Zhao, A. Hestvik

(Poster, 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP 2024), Ann Arbor, MI)

Professional Memberships

Society for the Neurobiology of Language